My Medi-Cal sign-up checklist

Check things off as you go. You don't need every paper to start, so apply anyway. (DHCS, n.d.-e)

1 Gather your papers

- [ ] Photo ID or driver's license
- [ ] Social Security card, if you have one
- [ ] Immigration papers, if you have them
- [ ] Latest pay stub
- [ ] Last tax return (Schedule C if self-employed)
- [ ] Benefit letters, like unemployment or disability
- [ ] Receipts for child care or child support you pay

Paid in cash? You may tell the county your income yourself. (DHCS, n.d.-e)

2 Apply one way

- [ ] Online at BenefitsCal.com or CoveredCA.com
- [ ] By phone with your county office (numbers below)
- [ ] In person at your county office
- [ ] By mail with a paper application in your language

You can apply any time of year. (DHCS, n.d.-a, n.d.-e)

3 After you apply

- [ ] Open every letter and text from the county
- [ ] Send any extra proof they ask for, fast
- [ ] Find a Medi-Cal dentist near you (Smile, California finder)
- [ ] Send back renewal forms on time

(DHCS, n.d.-d; Smile, California, n.d.-a)

4 Children's dental visits

- [ ] First visit by the first tooth or first birthday
- [ ] Checkup and cleaning every 6 months, covered by Medi-Cal
- [ ] Ask about sealants for back teeth

Babies up to 3 can get exams every 3 months. (Smile, California, n.d.-a, n.d.-c)

Phone numbers

Los Angeles County DPSS	**1-866-613-3777**	Riverside County DPSS	**1-877-410-8827**
San Bernardino County TAD	**1-877-410-8829**	Medi-Cal Dental	**1-800-322-6384**
Covered California	**1-800-300-1506**	Free legal help (HCA)	**1-888-804-3536**

Scan to see what Medi-Cal covers, find a clinic and get your next step in 3 taps.

Sources (APA 7, full list on the website): California Department of Health Care Services (DHCS). (n.d.-a) Apply for Medi-Cal; (n.d.-d) Medi-Cal changes; (n.d.-e) Medi-Cal help center. Smile, California. (n.d.-a) Covered services; (n.d.-c) Covered services: Kids. Phone numbers from each county and agency's own website, retrieved November 9, 2026.

Created by Joshua Chung, DMD Class of 2029, Western University of Health Sciences, for CSL II. Educational only, not legal or eligibility advice.